

Psy409 Final term Notes

Lesson 19 – HOPE (Sentence / Point Form)

Can Hope Be Measured? (Hope Scales)

Adult Hope Scale

- Snyder and his colleagues developed several self-report hope scales based on hope theory.
- Snyder, Harris et al. (1991) developed a **12-item trait hope scale**.
- This scale is for **adults aged 16 years and older**.
- **4 items measure pathways thinking**.
- **4 items measure agency thinking**.
- **4 items are distracters**.
- Example of a pathways item: *“I can think of many ways to get out of a jam.”*
- Example of an agency item: *“I energetically pursue my goals.”*
- Responses are given on an **8-point Likert scale**.
- Scale range is from **1 = definitely false** to **8 = definitely true**.
- Internal consistency (alpha) is usually around **.80**.
- Test–retest reliability is **.80 or higher** over **8–10 weeks**.
- The Hope Scale shows **positive correlations** with optimism, goal expectancy, perceived control, and self-esteem.
- It shows **negative correlations** with hopelessness, depression, and psychological pathology.
- Factor-analytic studies support the **two components: pathways and agency**.

Children’s Hope Scale (CHS)

- Developed by **Snyder, Hoza et al. (1997)**.
- It is a **6-item self-report trait scale**.
- Suitable for children aged **8 to 15 years**.
- **3 items measure agency thinking**.
- **3 items measure pathways thinking**.
- Example of agency item: *“I think I am doing pretty well.”*
- Example of pathways item: *“When I have a problem, I can come up with lots of ways to solve it.”*
- Responses are given on a **6-point Likert scale**.
- Scale range is from **1 = none of the time** to **6 = all of the time**.
- Alpha reliability values are close to **.80**.
- Test–retest reliability for one month ranges from **.70 to .80**.
- CHS shows **positive relationships with strengths** such as self-worth.
- It shows **negative relationships with problems** such as depression.
- Factor analysis supports the **two-factor structure (agency and pathways)**.

State Hope Scale (SHS)

- Developed by **Snyder et al. (1996)**.
- It is a **6-item self-report scale**.
- It measures **current or “here-and-now” goal-directed thinking**.
- **3 items measure pathways thinking**.
- Example of pathways item: *“There are lots of ways around any problem that I am facing now.”*
- **3 items measure agency thinking**.
- Example of agency item: *“At the present time, I am energetically pursuing my goals.”*
- Responses range from **1 = definitely false** to **8 = definitely true**.
- Internal reliability is very high, with alpha values often around **.90**.
- SHS scores correlate **positively with self-esteem and positive affect**.
- SHS scores correlate **negatively with negative affect**.
- Experimental studies show SHS scores **increase with success** and **decrease with failure**.
- Factor analysis supports the **two-factor structure of agency and pathways**.

What Does Hope Predict?

Hope and Health

- Hope contributes to positive changes during psychological treatment.
- Hope helps individuals cope better with illness and physical challenges.

Correlational Evidence

- Hope is positively related to coping with severe burns.
- Hope is positively related to coping with arthritis.
- Hope is positively related to coping with spinal cord injury.
- Hope is positively related to coping with blindness.
- Hope correlates with happiness and life satisfaction.
- Hope correlates with positive emotions.
- Hope correlates with good interpersonal relationships.

Cross-Sectional Evidence

- High-hope individuals remain energized during recovery.
- High-hope individuals experience less pain.
- High-hope individuals tolerate pain twice as long as low-hope individuals.

Hope and Academic Success

Correlational Evidence

- Higher hope scores at college entry predict higher GPA.
- Hope predicts whether students remain enrolled in college.

Cross-Sectional Evidence

- High-hope individuals make adaptive attributions for success and failure.
- 40% of low-hope students graduate within 6 years.
- 50% of moderate-hope students graduate within 6 years.
- 57% of high-hope students graduate within 6 years.

Longitudinal Evidence

- A six-year study showed hope predicts overall GPA.
- This prediction remains even after controlling entrance exam scores.

Hope and Sports Success

- Higher hope scores predict better athletic performance.
- Hope predicts performance beyond the coach's rating of ability.
- This effect was found especially among male athletes.
- Study conducted by **Curry et al. (1977)**.

Hope and Psychotherapy

- Hope is considered a **common factor** in successful psychological treatments.
- Hope underlies positive change in therapy.

Temporal Orientations

Past Orientation

- Past orientation emphasizes pleasurable memories of relationships.
- It focuses on happiness from warm interpersonal interactions.
- It can also lead to an overly cautious lifestyle.
- It may cause resistance to change and new experiences.
- Negative past orientation leads to rumination and anxiety.
- Negative past views can cause depressive feelings.
- Many psychological problems are linked to childhood trauma.

Present Orientation

- Present-oriented individuals live in the moment.
- They enjoy intense and exciting activities.
- They seek pleasure and novelty.
- Toddlers naturally live in the present moment.
- Excessive present orientation can lead to negative outcomes.
- These outcomes include addiction and risky behavior.
- Risks include unsafe driving, sexual behavior, and drug use.
- Islam emphasizes moderation to avoid such problems.

Future Orientation

- Future-oriented individuals think about consequences of actions.
- They set clear goals.
- They plan pathways to reach goals.
- They engage in preventive behaviors.
- They are successful in academics, careers, sports, and health.

Which Orientation Characterizes Your Life?

- Philip Zimbardo developed the **Time Perspective Inventory (1999)**.
- It is a **56-item scale**.
- It uses a **5-point Likert scale**.
- It measures five orientations:
 - Past-negative
 - Past-positive
 - Present-fatalistic
 - Present-hedonistic
 - Future

Personal Mini-Experiments

- Estimate time spent in past, present, and future.
- Divide time into morning, noon, and evening.
- Calculate total time orientation.

Testing Different Orientations

- Identify the most meaningful upcoming event.
- Consider how you will approach the event.
- Think about how orientation affects outcome.
- Consider alternative orientations and outcomes.

Toward a Balanced Time Perspective

- Work hard when it is time to work.
- Play intensely when it is time to play.
- Value stories and experiences of elders.
- See the world with curiosity like children.
- Enjoy humor and life's absurdities.
- Balance duties, pleasure, and meaning.

Lesson 20:

Life Enhancement Strategies for Subjective Well-Being

1. Relationships

- Identify your **explanatory style** (how you explain success or failure).
- Understand the role of explanatory style in **family success or failure**.
- Set **clear goals** to improve important relationships.
- Identify **pathways** to achieve relationship goals.
- Identify **sources of agency**, such as motivation and personal effort.

2. Work

- Expect **positive outcomes** in work life.
- Nurture and maintain **optimistic thoughts**.
- Focus on achieving **small goals one by one**.
- Direct energy toward gradual progress rather than distant big goals.

3. Play

- Observe and note **TV messages** that promote **self-efficacy**.
- Focus on media messages that encourage confidence and belief in abilities.

Resilience: Healthy Adjustment to Difficult Childhood

- Early theories assumed that a **poor family environment** always leads to unhealthy adult personality.
- Recent studies show that **poor early environments do not always result in psychological problems**.
- Some children grow up in **very difficult homes** and still become well-adjusted adults.
- Difficult backgrounds may include:
 - Chronic poverty
 - Parental neglect
 - Parental psychopathology
 - Abuse
 - Living in war-affected areas
- Early family environments are **extremely important**, but:
 - Some children learn to **adapt to difficult environments**
 - They are **less affected** than others

Example by Garmezy, Masten & Tellegen (1984)

- An 11-year-old boy from a:
 - Poor household
 - Alcoholic father
 - Troubled and depressed mother
 - Brothers involved in crime
 - Special-needs siblings
- Parents showed hopelessness and helplessness.
- Despite this, the boy:
 - Had good social relationships

- Was liked by everyone
- Was a good athlete
- Won several trophies
- Was well-mannered, bright, and disciplined

Psychological Resilience

- Early views saw humans as **passive and reactive** to stimuli.
- New perspective:
 - Humans are **active participants** in shaping their development.
 - People can **anticipate challenges** and prepare for them.
- Psychological resilience is defined as:
 - The ability to **withstand stress**
 - Not developing **mental illness or long-term negative mood**
- It refers to the capacity to:
 - Avoid psychopathology despite difficult life circumstances

Definition by Masten & Reed (2002)

- Resilience is:
 - “A class of phenomena characterized by **positive adaptation** in the context of significant adversity or risk.”

What is “Good Adaptation”?

- Researchers disagree on what “bouncing back” means.
- Good adaptation may involve:
 - Returning to **normal developmental functioning**
 - Achieving **above-average functioning** compared to peers
- Observers look for:
 - Attainment of developmental milestones
 - Evidence of excellence beyond expectations

External and Internal Adaptation

- Researchers agree that **external adaptation** is necessary:
 - Meeting social, educational, and occupational expectations
- There is disagreement about **internal adaptation**:
 - Whether positive psychological well-being is required
- Some believe both external success and internal well-being are essential.

Werner’s Studies (1995)

- Werner and Ruth Smith studied **700 children** born in Kauai, Hawaii.
- Study duration: **1955–1995**
- Data collected from:

- Children
 - Adult caregivers
- Many families worked in **sugarcane plantations**.
- One-third of children were considered **high-risk** due to:
 - Poverty
 - Parental alcoholism
 - Domestic violence
- These children were at risk for:
 - Academic problems
 - Social problems

Core Characteristics of Resilient Children (Werner, 1995)

1. Supportive Relationships

- Ability to emotionally detach from disturbed parents.
- Ability to find a **nurturing surrogate parent**.
- Temperament was:
 - Active
 - Affectionate
 - Good-natured
- Often formed close bonds with **teachers** as role models.

2. Social Skills

- Good social and communication skills.
- At least **one close friend**.
- Desire to help and nurture others.

3. Creative Outlets

- Engagement in hobbies, activities, or creative outlets.
- Activities provided:
 - Pride
 - Competence
 - Sense of mastery

4. Positive Outlook

- Belief that life would **work out well**.
- Optimism and **internal locus of control**.
- Positive self-concept.
- Coping style that balanced:
 - Autonomy
 - Asking for help when needed

5. Religious Beliefs

- Families held **religious beliefs**.
- Religion provided **meaning during difficult times**.

Promoting Resilience Across Gender (Werner, 1995)

Resilient Boys

- Structured households with rules.
- Presence of a **male role model**.
- Encouragement of **emotional expression**.

Resilient Girls

- Homes encouraging **risk-taking and independence**.
- Reliable support from an **older female figure**.

Study by E. J. Anthony (1987)

- Studied **300 children of schizophrenic parents** over 12 years.
- Found that:
 - About **10%** were very well-adjusted adults.
- Children thrived because:
 - They emotionally detached from disturbed parents.
- This view contrasts with traditional attachment theory.

Sybil & Wolin (2000)

- Interviewed adolescents and identified traits of resilient adults.
- These characteristics can be used in intervention strategies:
 - Insight
 - Independence
 - Good relationships
 - Initiative
 - Creativity
 - Humor
 - Strong moral standards

Lesson 21:

Resilience Resources & Strategies (Masten & Reed, 2002)

- Findings from case studies, qualitative research, and large-scale quantitative studies show **consistent resilience factors**.

- These factors support **positive adjustment and development** under life-threatening conditions.
- Resilience resources operate at **multiple levels**:
 - Child
 - Family
 - Relationships
 - Community

Resilience Resources Within the Child

- Good cognitive abilities.
- Strong problem-solving skills.
- Effective attention and focus.
- Easy temperament during infancy.
- Adaptable personality later in development.
- Positive self-perception.
- High self-efficacy.
- Faith and sense of meaning in life.
- Positive outlook on life.
- Good emotional regulation.
- Ability to control impulses.
- Talents valued by self and society.
- Good sense of humor.
- General attractiveness or appeal to others.

Resilience Resources Within the Family

- Close and secure relationships with caregiving adults.
- Authoritative parenting style:
 - High warmth
 - Clear structure and monitoring
 - High expectations
- Positive family climate.
- Low conflict or discord between parents.
- Organized home environment.
- Parents with post-secondary education.
- Parents who possess protective qualities.
- Parental involvement in child's education.
- Socioeconomic advantages.

Resilience Resources Within Family or Other Relationships

- Close relationships with competent adults.
- Supportive and prosocial adult figures.
- Connections with rule-abiding peers.
- Relationships with prosocial friends.

Resilience Resources Within the Community

- Presence of effective schools.
- Access to prosocial organizations:
 - Schools
 - Clubs
 - Scouting organizations
- Neighborhoods with high collective efficacy.
- High levels of public safety.
- Availability of emergency social services.
- Good public health services.
- Accessible health care facilities.

Risk-Focused Strategies

Preventing or Reducing Risk and Stressors

- Prevent low birth weight and prematurity through proper parental care.
- Prevent child abuse and neglect via parent education.
- Reduce teenage smoking, drinking, and drug use through community programs.
- Prevent homelessness through housing policies and emergency aid.
- Reduce neighborhood crime through community policing.

Asset-Focused Strategies

Increasing Resources and Social Capital

- Provide tutoring support.
- Organize boys' or girls' clubs.
- Offer parent education classes.
- Build recreational centers.
- Increase availability of quality developmental resources.

Process-Focused Strategies

Mobilizing Human Adaptational Systems

- Build self-efficacy using graduated success teaching models.
- Teach coping strategies for specific stressful situations.
- Prepare children for medical procedures such as surgery.
- Foster secure attachment through parental sensitivity training.
- Conduct home visit programs for new parents and infants.
- Encourage mentoring relationships.
- Match children with trained mentors.
- Promote friendships with prosocial peers.
- Encourage participation in extracurricular activities.

- Support cultural traditions and adaptive rituals.
- Promote bonding with prosocial adults through:
 - Religious education
 - Cultural classes
 - Meditation practices taught by elders

Positive Youth Development Programs (PYDP)

- Positive youth development is an **ongoing and universal process**.
- All youth are involved and invested in development.
- Youth interact with:
 - Their environment
 - Positive agents of change
- Positive agents include:
 - Supportive adults
 - Development-friendly institutions
 - Growth-oriented programs
- These programs help youth:
 - Meet basic needs
 - Develop personal assets

Forms of Positive Youth Development Programs (Benson & Saito, 2000)

- Structured or semi-structured activities.
- Organizations offering positive relationships.
- Socializing systems promoting growth:
 - Schools
 - Daycare centers
 - Libraries
 - Museums
- Community-based systems that combine programs and institutions.
- Program effectiveness depends on:
 - Promoting positive outcomes
 - Preventing negative behaviors

Developmental Programs

Big Brothers and Big Sisters

- Community-based mentoring program started in 1905.
- Provides 3–5 contact hours per week.
- No participation fee.
- Targets low-income children and adolescents.
- Matches youth with trained adult volunteers.
- Mentors provide:
 - Support

- Care
 - Guidance
- Mentors are carefully screened and trained.

Penn Resiliency Program (Gillham & Reivich, 2004)

- Highly structured life-skills program.
- Delivered in school settings.
- Conducted by trained facilitators.
- Consists of 12 scripted sessions.
- Focuses on:
 - Awareness of thought patterns
 - Changing explanatory styles
- Encourages flexible and accurate attributions.
- Proven outcomes:
 - Reduced depressive symptoms
 - Increased optimism
 - Better physical health

What Makes Programs Beneficial?

1. **More is better**
 - Greater time investment leads to better outcomes.
2. **Earlier is better**
 - Younger participants show higher competence development.
3. **Structured is better**
 - Purposeful and systematic programs are more effective.
 - Structured programs are easier to replicate.

Studies of Adult Development

Lewis Terman's Study

- Lewis Terman studied intelligence as an adaptive trait.
- He believed intelligence leads to:
 - Life success
 - National leadership
- In the 1920s, he studied 1500 gifted children.
- Children had IQs above 140.
- Participants were nominated by teachers in California.
- They called themselves the “**Termites**.”

Peterson et al. (1998)

- Studied the childhood explanatory styles of the Termites.
- Found that catastrophizing explanatory style:

- Explaining bad events with global causes
- Predicted higher mortality risk.
- Even in healthy children, pessimistic thinking had long-term effects.

Primary Tasks of Adulthood (George Vaillant, 2002)

Vaillant identified key adult life tasks using Terman data.

1. Identity

- Develops in adolescence or early adulthood.
- Personal values, beliefs, and interests become independent.
- Identity is no longer a reflection of caregivers.

2. Intimacy

- Develops after identity formation.
- Ability to form committed and interdependent relationships.
- Emotional closeness and trust are central.

3. Career Consolidation

- Development of social and professional identity.
- Involves:
 - Contentment
 - Compensation
 - Competence
 - Commitment

4. Generativity

- Involves contributing to society.
- Focus on giving back to others.
- Building a broader social network.
- Sharing skills, care, and responsibility.

5. Keeper of Meaning

- Some adults become guides or mentors.
- They gain wisdom about life and society.
- They willingly share experiences and insights.

6. Integrity

- Final adult developmental task.
- Leads to inner peace and life satisfaction.

- Often accompanied by:
 - Increased spirituality
 - Deeper commitment to life

Lesson 22:

What is Successful Aging?

- The concept of successful aging was popularized by **Robert Havighurst (1961)**.
- He described successful aging as “**adding life to years**”, not just adding years to life.
- Successful aging focuses on:
 - Quality of life
 - Well-being
 - Active engagement in later life

MacArthur Foundation Study of Successful Aging

- Conducted between **1988 and 1996**.
- Led by **John Rowe** and a multidisciplinary research team.
- Focused on:
 - Physical factors
 - Social factors
 - Psychological factors
- Examined abilities, health, and well-being in older adults.

Sample Details

- 1189 healthy adults aged **70–79 years**.
- Selected from 4030 potential participants.
- Selection was based on:
 - Physical health
 - Cognitive functioning
- Participants completed:
 - 90-minute personal interviews
 - Periodic follow-ups for an average of **7 years**

Three Components of Successful Aging (MacArthur Study)

1. Avoiding disease and disability.
2. Maintaining physical and cognitive functioning.
3. Active engagement with life.

Support Required for Successful Aging

- Social support is most effective when it is **mutual**.
- Support must be **balanced between giving and receiving**.

Two Types of Support

1. Socioemotional support

- Love
- Liking
- Emotional care

2. Instrumental support

- Practical assistance
- Help during need

Key Findings

- Social support increased over time.
- Individuals with more social ties showed:
 - Fewer functional declines
- Effects varied based on:
 - Gender
 - Baseline physical health

Gender Differences in Support

- Men mainly received emotional support from spouses.
- Women relied more on:
 - Friends
 - Relatives
 - Children

Productive Activity in Later Adulthood

- Studied by **Glass et al. (1995)**.
- Compared:
 - Highly functioning adults
 - Moderate-to-low functioning adults
- Highly functioning adults were:
 - More productive
- Declines in productivity were associated with:
 - Hospital admissions
 - Strokes
- Protective factors included:
 - Marriage
 - Skill mastery
- Sustained physical activity helps maintain well-being.
- Interruptions in activity often cause declines in health.

Lifestyle Predictors of Successful Aging (Vaillant, 2002)

- Vaillant used **objective evaluations**, not self-reports.
- Based on the **Study of Adult Development**.
- Participants:
 - 256 Caucasian, socially advantaged men
 - Selected in the late 1930s at Harvard
- Over 80% lived past age 80.
- Only 30% of their peers reached that age.

Lifestyle Predictors

- Not smoking or quitting early.
- Adaptive coping with mature defenses.
- No alcohol abuse.
- Maintaining healthy weight.
- Stable marriage.
- Regular physical exercise.
- Higher education.

Predictors of Health

- Compared two groups:
 - **Happy-well**
 - **Sad-sick**
- Happy-well group showed:
 - Good physical and mental health
 - High life satisfaction
- Strongest predictor:
 - Use of **mature psychological defenses**
- Examples of mature defenses:
 - Altruism
 - Humor

Successful Aging & Positive Emotions

- Study by **Danner et al. (2001)**.
- Analyzed autobiographies of **180 Catholic nuns**.
- Written in early adulthood.
- Findings:
 - Positive emotional content predicted longer life.
 - Higher positivity → lower mortality risk 60 years later.
- Positive life stories were linked to:
 - Living beyond 70s and 80s

Personal Mini-Experiments

Test Mentorship Effectiveness

- One caring adult can change a child's life.
- Mentorship can enhance resilience.
- Effectiveness can be tested through:
 - Community-based mentoring programs

Build a Stronger Social Circle

- Social connections are key adult life tasks.
- Exercise:
 - Draw four circles
 - Center circle labeled "Me"
 - Add names based on closeness
- Reflect on:
 - Maintaining close relationships
 - Strengthening weaker connections
- Act by giving time or talent to someone close.

Collect Stories of Successful Aging

- Interview people aged **60 and above**.
- Ask about:
 - Career or retirement enjoyment
 - Vacations
 - Important relationships after age 50
- Analyze responses to understand:
 - Successful aging in the community

Wisdom and Courage

- Wisdom and courage are two of the **four cardinal virtues**:
 - Prudence
 - Justice
 - Fortitude (courage)
 - Temperance
- These virtues promote:
 - Personal development
 - Moral and social good
- Courage helps overcome obstacles.
- Wisdom guides sound decision-making.
- Both contribute to:
 - Individual excellence
 - Community welfare

Difference Between Wisdom and Courage

- Wisdom involves:

- Sound judgment
 - Thoughtful decision-making
- Courage involves:
 - Acting despite fear
- Confusing courage with wisdom can lead to errors.
- Both qualities can exist in ordinary people.

What is Wisdom?

Definitions

- Wisdom is expert knowledge and judgment about:
 - Life's meaning
 - Difficult and uncertain situations
(Baltes & Kunzmann, 2003)
- Wisdom reflects:
 - Cognitive maturity
 - Emotional maturity
 - Behavioral maturity
(Kramer, 2000)

Components of Wisdom

- Knowing what you know.
- Knowing what you do not know.
- Knowing what can be known.
- Knowing what cannot be known.

Wisdom in Islam

- Sources of wisdom:
 - Holy Quran
 - Sayings of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ
- Allah is the source of:
 - Justice (Adl)
 - Benevolence (Ihsan)
 - Compassion (Rahmah)
 - Wisdom (Hikmah)
- Hikmah combines:
 - Reason (Aql)
 - Compassion (Rahmah)
- Allah's name **Al-Hakim** reflects wisdom.
- Misuse of intellect increases human suffering.
- True wisdom reduces suffering and violence.

Sayings of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ

- “God has not created anything better than Reason.”
- Reason guides moral and just behavior.

Hazrat Ali (RA) and Wisdom

- Hazrat Ali emphasized:
 - Wisdom as the greatest wealth.
 - Ignorance as the greatest poverty.
- He believed:
 - Knowledge is the noblest inheritance.
 - Deep thinking clarifies problems.
- Advised moderation in all matters.
- Wisdom protects actions from harm.

Lesson 23:

Implicit Theories of Wisdom

- Implicit theories explain the **basic elements** of wisdom.
- They are based on **people’s everyday understanding** of wisdom.

Clayton’s Study (1975)

- One of the first systematic studies on wisdom.
- Participants rated **similarities between words** related to wisdom.
- Examples of words:
 - Empathic
 - Experienced
 - Intelligent
 - Introspective
 - Intuitive
 - Knowledgeable
 - Observant
- Used **multidimensional scaling** (statistical method).

Three Dimensions of Wisdom (Clayton, 1975)

1. **Affective Dimension**
 - Empathy
 - Compassion
2. **Reflective Dimension**
 - Intuition
 - Introspection
3. **Cognitive Dimension**
 - Experience
 - Intelligence

Wisdom in Cultural and Historical Writings (Baltes, 1993)

- Wisdom is reflected in **language, culture, and philosophy**.
- Analysis of cultural-historical writings showed that wisdom:
 1. Addresses **important and difficult life matters**.
 2. Involves **superior knowledge, judgment, and advice**.
 3. Reflects **deep, broad, and balanced knowledge** applicable to life situations.
 4. Is **well-intended** and combines **mind and virtue**.
 5. Is **difficult to achieve** but **easy to recognize**.

Explicit Theories of Wisdom

- Explicit theories focus on **behavioral expressions** of wisdom.
- They are influenced by:
 - Personality theories (Erikson, 1959)
 - Cognitive development theories (Piaget, 1932)
- These theories emphasize:
 - Application of knowledge
 - Exceptional human functioning

Stage Theories of Wisdom

Piaget's Cognitive Development Theory (1932)

Children move through stages:

1. **Sensorimotor Stage**
 - Knowledge through sensing and action.
2. **Preoperational Stage**
 - Use of symbols and imagination.
3. **Concrete Operational Stage**
 - Logical thinking about concrete events.
4. **Formal Operational Stage**
 - Abstract reasoning and hypothesis testing.

Reigel's Postformal Stage (1973)

- Introduced **dialectical operations stage**.
- This stage is also referred to as **wisdom**.
- Characteristics:
 - Reflective thinking
 - Balance of information
 - Truth understood in cultural and historical context
- Dialectical thinking involves:
 - Integration of opposing viewpoints

- Use of both logical and subjective thinking
- Integration of motivation and life experiences

Life-Span Theories of Wisdom

- Wisdom is part of **optimal human development**.
- Erikson (1959):
 - Wisdom reflects maturity.
 - Personal interests are replaced by concern for **collective good**.
- Orwoll (1989):
 - Wise individuals show:
 - Integrity
 - Strong concern for society and humanity

Balance Theory & Berlin Wisdom Paradigm

- **Sternberg's Balance Theory (1998)**
- **Baltes's Berlin Wisdom Paradigm (1990)**

Common Features of Both Theories

Wise people are able to:

1. Understand perspectives of others.
2. Develop deep understanding of the world.
3. Create meaningful solutions to complex problems.
4. Act for the **common good**.

Robert Sternberg's Balance Theory of Wisdom

- Developed by Yale psychologist **Robert Sternberg**.
- Wisdom involves:
 - Balancing self-interest
 - Balancing others' interests
 - Balancing environmental demands
- Goal of wisdom:
 - Achievement of the **common good**

Key Concepts

- Based on **tacit knowledge**:
 - "Knowing how" rather than "knowing what"
- Wisdom is the willingness to:
 - Use skills and knowledge accurately
 - Act in a valid and ethical manner

Berlin Wisdom Paradigm (Baltes, 1990)

- Wisdom is:
 - Expertise in **life planning**
 - Understanding the **meaning of life**
- Defined as:
 - “Expertise in the conduct and meaning of life”

Five Criteria of Wisdom (Baltes)

1. **Factual Knowledge**
 - Knowledge of:
 - Human development
 - Individual differences
 - Social norms and relationships
2. **Procedural Knowledge**
 - Strategies for:
 - Problem-solving
 - Giving advice
 - Resolving life conflicts
 - Planning and overcoming obstacles
3. **Life-Span Contextualism**
 - Considering:
 - Life domains (love, work, play)
 - Cultural values
 - Time and life stages
4. **Relativism of Values**
 - Understanding:
 - Differences in values
 - Cultural diversity
 - Life priorities across societies
5. **Managing Uncertainty**
 - Flexibility in decision-making
 - Handling incomplete or complex information

Assessment of Wisdom (Baltes)

- Individuals are given **real-life dilemmas**.
- Responses are:
 - Transcribed
 - Rated using the five wisdom criteria
- Tasks include:
 - Advising others (life management)
 - Reflecting on personal life problems

Importance of Wisdom in Modern Times

- Technological development has increased rapidly.
- Growth in **destructive technology** is not matched with wisdom.
- Lack of wisdom in using technology:
 - Increases global risk
 - Intensifies human suffering
- Wisdom is essential to:
 - Guide ethical decisions
 - Ensure technology benefits humanity

Lesson 24:

Implicit Theories of Wisdom

- Implicit theories explain the **basic elements** of wisdom.
- Clayton (1975) conducted one of the **earliest systematic studies** on wisdom.
- Participants rated similarities between words related to wisdom (e.g., empathic, intelligent, intuitive).
- Using **multidimensional scaling**, Clayton identified **three dimensions of wisdom**:
 - **Affective dimension** → empathy and compassion.
 - **Reflective dimension** → intuition and introspection.
 - **Cognitive dimension** → experience and intelligence.

Wisdom in Cultural & Historical Writings (Baltes, 1993)

Wisdom, as found in cultural and philosophical writings:

- Deals with **important and difficult life matters**.
- Involves **superior knowledge, judgment, and advice**.
- Reflects knowledge with **depth, balance, and broad application** to life situations.
- Combines **intellect with moral virtue** and good intentions.
- Is **hard to achieve** but **easy to recognize** in others.

Explicit Theories of Wisdom

- Explicit theories focus on **observable behaviors** of wisdom.
- These theories are influenced by:
 - **Personality theories** (Erikson, 1959).
 - **Cognitive development theories** (Piaget, 1932).
- They emphasize the **practical application of knowledge** for optimal functioning.

Stage Theories of Wisdom

- Piaget (1932) described stages of cognitive development:
 - Sensorimotor stage → learning through senses and actions.
 - Preoperational stage → symbolic thinking.
 - Concrete operational stage → logical thinking.

- Formal operational stage → hypothesis testing and abstract reasoning.
- Reigel (1973) proposed a **postformal stage** called the **dialectical operations stage**.
- This stage represents **wisdom**.
- Dialectical thinking includes:
 - Reflective thinking.
 - Balancing information.
 - Understanding truth within **cultural and historical contexts**.
 - Integrating opposing viewpoints.
 - Combining logic with subjective experiences.
 - Integrating motivation and life experiences.

Life-Span Theories of Wisdom

- Life-span theorists view wisdom as part of **optimal human development**.
- Erikson (1959) believed:
 - Wisdom reflects maturity.
 - Personal interests are replaced by concern for the **collective good**.
- Orwoll (1989) found that wise individuals showed:
 - High integrity.
 - Strong concern for society and others.

Balance Theory & Berlin Wisdom Paradigm

Both theories emphasize **pragmatic knowledge**.

Wise people are able to:

- Understand others' perspectives.
- Develop a deep understanding of the world.
- Create meaningful solutions to complex problems.
- Act in ways that promote the **common good**.

Robert Sternberg's Balance Theory of Wisdom

- Sternberg (1998) defined wisdom as:
 - Balancing personal, interpersonal, and societal interests.
 - Adapting to environmental contexts.
 - Aiming to achieve the **common good**.
- Wisdom relies on **tacit knowledge** (knowing how, not just knowing what).
- Wisdom involves:
 - Willingness to use skills and knowledge accurately.
 - Applying intelligence and creativity responsibly.

Berlin Wisdom Paradigm (Baltes, 1990)

- Wisdom is defined as:
 - Expertise in the **conduct and meaning of life**.

- Five criteria of wisdom:
 1. **Factual knowledge** → understanding human nature, development, social norms.
 2. **Procedural knowledge** → problem-solving, giving advice, resolving conflicts.
 3. **Life-span contextualism** → considering age, culture, life domains, and time.
 4. **Relativism of values** → respecting differences in values and priorities.
 5. **Managing uncertainty** → flexibility in decision-making.
- Wisdom is assessed by:
 - Life-planning tasks.
 - Life-review and life-management problems.

Importance of Wisdom in Modern Times

- Technological progress has increased rapidly.
- Wisdom has not developed at the same pace.
- This imbalance creates **serious global risks**.
- Wisdom is essential for responsible use of technology.

Wisdom & Intelligence

- Intelligence helps with **daily tasks**.
- Wisdom helps solve **major life problems**.
- Crystallized intelligence is **time-bound**.
- Wisdom is **timeless** and endures across generations.

Development of Wisdom

- Influenced by theorists like Piaget, Jung, and Erikson.
- Wisdom develops through:
 - Resolving life conflicts.
 - Daily crises (integrity vs despair – Erikson).
 - Resolving inner psychic conflicts (Jung).
- Wisdom builds on:
 - Knowledge.
 - Cognitive skills.
 - Personality traits.
 - Cultural understanding.
- Exposure to **wise role models** enhances wisdom.
- Sternberg emphasized:
 - Knowledge.
 - Thinking style.
 - Motivation.
 - Environment.
- Baltes & Staudinger (2000) emphasized:
 - Fluid intelligence.
 - Creativity.
 - Openness.

- Life experience.
- Mentorship.

Predictors of Wisdom

Gender & Wisdom

- Wisdom combines masculine and feminine qualities.
- Men's wisdom is often expressed publicly.
- Women's wisdom is often expressed privately.
- Social roles influence how wisdom is expressed.

Profession & Wisdom

- Clinical psychologists show higher wisdom-related performance.
- Professional specialization influences wisdom.
- People inclined toward wisdom may choose psychology careers.

Age & Wisdom

- No significant age differences between 25–75 years.
- Wisdom may decline after late seventies.
- Ages 15–25 are critical for wisdom development.

What Does Wisdom Predict?

- Childhood does not strongly affect wisdom.
- Early adulthood social environment matters.
- Wise individuals show **greater life satisfaction**.

Measurement of Wisdom

- Methods include:
 - Self-report questionnaires.
 - Sentence completion tasks.
 - Problem-solving tasks.
- Sternberg proposed standardized wisdom tests.
- Baltes designed life-problem tasks.

VIA Wisdom Measure (Peterson & Seligman, 2004)

Wisdom includes five traits:

- Curiosity.
- Love of learning.
- Open-mindedness.

- Creativity.
- Perspective.

Self-Assessed Wisdom Scale (SAWS – Webster, 2003)

Measures:

- Experience with moral dilemmas.
- Emotional awareness.
- Reminiscence.
- Openness to new ideas.
- Sense of humor.

Lesson 25:

What is Courage?

- Courage is a **universal human virtue**, just like wisdom.
- Socrates was one of the earliest philosophers linked with courage.
- He believed knowledge is the basis of rational debate.
- In 399 BC, Socrates chose to **drink poison (hemlock)** rather than accept unjust official views.
- His act is considered a classic example of **moral courage**.

Defining Courage

- **Plato** defined courage as:
 - “The ability to remember what is worth prizing and what is worth fearing.”
- **Seligman (2001)** defined courage as:
 - “The capacity to rise to the occasion.”
- **Woodard (2004)** defined courage as:
 - Acting for a meaningful cause despite fear and limited resources.
- **Cicero** viewed courage as:
 - Magnificence.
 - Confidence.
 - Patience.
 - Perseverance.

Implicit Theories of Courage

- O’Byrne, Lopez, and Petersen (2000) studied people’s everyday views of courage.
- They surveyed **97 individuals**.
- Findings showed **wide variation** in how courage is perceived:
 - Some see courage as an **attitude** (e.g., optimism).
 - Others see it as a **behavior** (e.g., saving a life).
 - Some focus on **mental strength**.

- Others focus on **physical strength**.
- Some believe courage involves **risk-taking**.
- Others emphasize the role of **fear**.
- Fear and risk are **not present in all definitions** of courage.
- Across cultures and history, courage is valued because it helps people **face challenges**.
- Early philosophers shaped ideas of courage:
 - **Aristotle** focused on physical courage (the brave soldier).
 - **Plato** emphasized **moral courage**.

Implicit Theories: Peterson & Seligman (2004)

- In the **Values in Action (VIA) classification**, courage is a core human virtue.
- Courage consists of several character strengths:
 - **Valor** → taking physical, emotional, or intellectual stands despite danger.
 - **Authenticity** → being sincere and true to oneself.
 - **Enthusiasm/Zest** → showing vitality in challenging situations.
 - **Industry/Perseverance** → completing tasks despite obstacles.

Implicit Theories: O'Byrne et al. (2000)

They identified **three types of courage**:

1. Physical courage
2. Moral courage
3. Vital courage

Physical Courage

- Physical courage involves protecting society through **physical action**.
- It is aimed at achieving **socially valued goals**.
- Example:
 - A firefighter rescuing a child from a burning building.
- Physical courage evolved from the Greek concept **andreia**.
- In ancient Greece, it referred mainly to **military bravery**.

Rachman's Research on Courage

- Jack Rachman studied courage as the **opposite of fear**.
- He observed that people respond differently to danger.
- Rachman (1984) studied:
 - Paratroopers.
 - Soldiers.
 - Bomb squad members.
- Key findings:
 - Courageous people **persist despite fear**.
 - They recover **quickly** after fear-inducing situations.

- Courage is:
 - Not limited to special people.
 - Not always public.
- Rachman emphasized **private and inner courage**, especially in psychotherapy clients.

Moral Courage

- Moral courage is the expression of **authenticity** despite:
 - Disapproval.
 - Rejection.
 - Conflict.
- Example:
 - A politician voting for the common good despite unpopularity.
- According to **Quaid-e-Azam**, moral courage involves:
 - Justice.
 - Service to the common good.
- Moral courage is closely linked with:
 - Authenticity.
 - Integrity.
- It requires standing up for values even when it is uncomfortable.

Examples of Moral Courage

- **Mother Teresa:**
 - Served the poor.
 - Took strong moral positions despite opposition.
- **Nelson Mandela:**
 - Spent 27 years in prison.
 - Fought for equality in South Africa.
- **Doctors and nurses:**
 - Must speak the truth about diagnosis and prognosis.
 - Courage is required to **speak** and **hear** difficult truths.

Moral Courage in Daily Life

- Moral courage is an **equal-opportunity virtue**.
- Everyone faces situations requiring moral courage.
- It does not require special training.
- It often involves discomfort and dissension.
- People may need moral courage to:
 - Confront ageism.
 - Confront racism.
 - Confront sexism.
- Taking a stand against injustice reflects moral courage.

Historical Example of Moral Courage

- Gay Block and Malka Drucker interviewed **105 rescuers** from 10 countries.
- These rescuers helped Jews during wartime atrocities.
- Their courageous acts included:
 - Hiding Jews.
 - Sharing food.
 - Smuggling people out of ghettos.
 - Raising Jewish children as their own.
- These acts showed **humanity in times of barbarism**.
- Their behavior is a powerful example of **moral courage**.

Lesson 26:

Psychological Courage

- Psychological courage is the **strength to face one's destructive habits**.
- It is common because everyone faces **stress, sadness, or unhealthy relationships**.
- We use psychological courage by **changing beliefs** or **gradually confronting fears**.
- Putman (1997) argued that **training for psychological courage is rare** compared to physical or moral courage.
- Pop culture shows many **physically and morally courageous icons**, but **psychologically courageous figures are rare**.
- This may be because of **stigma around mental health and destructive behaviors**.

Vital Courage

- Vital courage is **persevering through illness or disability** even when the outcome is uncertain.
- Example: A **child with a heart transplant** continuing treatment despite unclear prognosis.
- Patients show vital courage by **enduring surgeries and treatments**.
- **Health professionals** (doctors, nurses) support patients using their expertise.
- Research shows that **vital courage involves awareness of short- and long-term effects of illness** (Haase, 1987).
- Middle-aged and older adults show courage by **accepting threats, solving problems, and developing self-awareness** (Finfgeld, 1995 & 1998).
- Courage is a **lifelong process** involving **hope, values, and support from others**.

Courage of Family & Caregivers

- Family and friends show vital courage by **supporting the sick person**.
- They **share suffering vicariously** and face their own fears.
- Example: Groopman (2004) described a **mother with colon cancer and her teenage daughter coping together**.

Famous Examples of Vital Courage

- **Christopher Reeve** – Superman actor, fought for **spinal cord and stem cell research** despite paralysis, died in 2004.
- **Professor Stephen Hawking** – Diagnosed with **motor neuron disease at 22**, contributed to physics for over 40 years using **wheelchair and computer**, remained **world-renowned**.

Measuring Courage

- **Larsen & Giles (1976)** – measured **existential (moral) and social (physical) courage**.
- **Schmidt & Koselka (2000)** – 7-item scale, measured **general and panic-specific courage**.
- **Woodard (2004)** – 31-item scale; courage = **acting for a meaningful cause despite fear**.
- **VIA Inventory of Strengths (Peterson & Seligman, 2004)** – measures 4 types of courage: **valor, authenticity, zest, and perseverance**.
- Measuring courage is **complex** because it can be **tonic (constant)** or **phasic (situation-specific)**.

Fear and Courage

- Courage often involves **fear**; true courage = **acting despite fear**.
- Rachman (1984) – scared people can act courageously.
- Physiological studies (bomb operators, paratroopers) show that **experienced courageous people respond differently to fear**.
- Example: **Paratroopers reported fear initially, but courage reduced their fear after jumps**.

Can Courage be Learned?

- Courage = **personal strength** to act when others do not.
- It involves acting **despite fear, hardship, or danger**.
- Example: **Winston Churchill** – faced rejection and failures for 20+ years but remained steadfast, eventually leading Britain in WWII.
- Stephen Mansfield: Courage **cannot be taught but can be inspired**; it arises from **faith, commitment, or hardship**.

Lesson 27:

Importance of Courage

- **Quaid-e-Azam** emphasized courage, hope, and confidence to face national challenges.
- Courage helps **mobilize resources in a disciplined way** to tackle serious issues.
- **Winston Churchill** said: Courage is the **first of human qualities** because it guarantees all other qualities.

Value of Wisdom & Courage

- Understanding wisdom may require **more wisdom** itself.
- Understanding courage requires **a good bit of wisdom**.
- **Stupid fearlessness** (e.g., eating insects on TV shows) is **not true courage**.
- **Wisdom and courage have evolutionary value**; they guide actions and promote survival of ideas and people.
- **Physical and vital courage** can **extend life**; **moral courage** preserves **justice and fairness**.

Personal Mini-Experiments

The Wisdom Challenge

- Consider a life event: “A 15-year-old girl wants to get married immediately.”
- Think aloud and write down your considerations.
- Ask questions like: What are **factual, procedural, and long-term considerations**?
- Evaluate your questions against the **five criteria of wisdom**:
 1. Factual knowledge
 2. Procedural knowledge
 3. Life-span contextualism
 4. Relativism of values
 5. Recognition and management of uncertainty

The Controversial Courage Debate

- Discuss a provocative issue in a group: e.g., “Are suicide bombers courageous?”
- Focus on **personal definitions of courage**.
- Consider **whose common good** is served.
- Apply **flexible thinking** and **value relativism**.

Life Enhancement Strategies

Relationships

- Balancing relationships with work requires **wisdom**.
- Identify a **wise role model** in family/friends.
- Interview them and find **four wise acts** they perform to maintain balance.

Work

- Stand up for **justice** when rights are violated.
- Display **moral courage** when actions are warranted.
- Don’t avoid acting due to **uncertainty of outcome**.

Mindfulness & Optimal Experiences

- Habitual, mindless experiences give **short-term relief**, but often **leave people bored**.

- **Intentional moment-to-moment experiences** give **joy and fulfillment**.
- Mindfulness leads to **sanity, competence, and meaningful engagement**.

Objectives of Mindfulness

- Describe what **mindfulness** is.
- Explain the **relationship between mindfulness and attention**.
- Understand mindfulness as a **search for novelty**.

Moment-to-Moment Searches (Kahneman, 2002)

- A day has about **20,000 moments of 3 seconds each** to engage positively.
- Mindfulness = **actively noticing opportunities in each moment**.
- Adding intentionality allows for:
 1. **Novelty** (new experiences)
 2. **Absorption / Flow**
 3. **Spirituality / attention to the sacred**

What is Mindfulness?

- Mindfulness = **cultivating awareness** of everyday events and sensations.
- Similar to **Buddhist awareness practices** and **modern cognitive therapies**.
- Mindfulness = **flexible mind, openness to novelty, sensitivity to context**.
- Mindlessness = **rigid thinking, trapped by rules and routines**.

Mindfulness & Attention

- Mindfulness is **not just vigilance or fixed attention**.
- It involves **actively varying focus and noticing new distinctions**.
- It is **not controlled processing**, but encourages **novelty and engagement**.

Mindfulness: In Search of Novelty

- People express mindfulness in **everyday behaviors**.
- Example (Wrzesniewski): **Hospital cleaners** viewed work as a calling → improved **patient experience**.
- Mindful acts included:
 1. Adjusting room layouts for patients
 2. Improving the environment day by day
 3. Making intentional choices in tasks
 4. Benefiting others through awareness
- Example (Langer, Harvard):
 - **Older adults given choice over plants** → more alert, happier, and engaged.
 - Shows that **making mindful choices increases life satisfaction**.

Lesson 28:

Characteristics of Mindfulness

- Mindfulness involves **drawing novel distinctions** and requires us to:
 1. Accept uncertainty instead of always trying to reduce it.
 2. Override automatic, habitual behaviors.
 3. Evaluate ourselves, others, and situations **less frequently**.
- **Uncertainty** keeps us grounded in the present.
 - Trying to control life too much can **increase uncertainty**.
 - Example: A child trying to hold a playful kitten — the more control attempted, the more it wriggles.
 - Mindfulness allows us to **embrace change without fear**.

Automaticity of Behavior

- Automatic behaviors = **quick, well-practiced responses** to familiar situations.
 - Example: Answering a phone automatically.
- Automatic responses may **ignore novelty** in the moment.
- Langer et al. (1978) study:
 - Standard memos → 90% returned (automatic behavior).
 - Novel memos → 60% returned (attention to novelty reduced automaticity).
- Mindfulness helps us **notice novelty** instead of acting automatically.

Mindfulness Discourages Evaluation

- Evaluation = **judging self, others, or situations**.
- Mindfulness reduces unnecessary judgments.
- **Bishop et al. (2004)**: Mindfulness involves:
 - Self-regulated attention to present experience.
 - Emotional openness → accepting all internal experiences.
- Mindfulness involves **metacognition and emotional awareness**.

Mindfulness Qualities (Shapiro et al., 2002)

1. **Nonjudging** – Observe without categorizing or evaluating.
2. **Nonstriving** – Non-goal-oriented, unattached to outcomes.
3. **Acceptance** – Acknowledge things as they are without passivity.
4. **Patience** – Let things unfold in their own time.
5. **Trust** – Trust yourself, intuition, emotions, and life's unfolding.
6. **Openness** – See things as if for the first time; pay attention to feedback.
7. **Letting go** – Nonattachment to thoughts, feelings, or experiences.
8. **Gentleness** – Soft, considerate, and tender approach.
9. **Generosity** – Giving in the present without expectation of return.
10. **Empathy** – Understand others' perspectives and emotions.
11. **Gratitude** – Appreciate and be thankful for the present.
12. **Loving-kindness** – Benevolence, forgiveness, and unconditional love.

Mindfulness & Meditation

- Mindfulness meditation = **deliberate practice** to develop:
 - Deep insight into mental processes, consciousness, identity, and reality.
 - Optimal psychological well-being through “opening up.”

Benefits of Mindfulness Meditation

- **Shapiro et al. (1998)**: Increased empathy, decreased anxiety & depression in medical students.
- **Astin (1997)**: Increased spiritual experience in undergraduates.
- Benefits maintained during **stressful periods** and **replicated in control groups**.

Cultivating Mindfulness

Method	Description	Focus / Strategy
Attention Training (Wells & Matthews, 1994)	Reduce self-focused attention	Complete selective & rapid switching tasks, auditory soundscapes
Mindfulness Meditation (Kabat-Zinn, 1990)	Pay attention to present moment	Sit quietly, observe experiences, notice without judgment
Mindfulness Training (Langer, 1989)	Reconfigure perceptions, break habitual behavior	Focus on novelty, multiple perspectives, awareness of context

Study by Gordon Spence (2005)

- **6-week randomized trial**, 72 participants, 3 groups + control.

Group 1: Attention Training

- Reduce self-focused attention through **auditory tasks** and homework.
- Goal: Improve **attentional control** by changing processing routines.

Group 2: Mindfulness Meditation

- Deepen attention & awareness, pay attention **without judgment**.
- Meditation = **intentional, systematic, human activity**, noticing **present moment**.

Group 3: Mindfulness Training

- 6 weeks of **mindful creativity** through **freely chosen projects**.

Measures of Mindfulness

- **Mindful Attention Awareness Scale (15-items)**
- Measures awareness of everyday attention.
- Example items:
 - “I forget a person’s name almost as soon as I’ve been told it.”
 - “I snack without being aware that I’m eating.”

Lesson 29:

Personal Mini-Experiments: Increasing Mindfulness in Relationships

- Mindfulness behaviors include:
 - **Nonjudging** – Observe the present without evaluation.
 - **Nonstriving** – Stay unattached to outcomes, act without forcing things.
- **Experiment:**
 - Practice nonjudging and nonforcing for **one day** in a significant relationship.
 - Be an impartial witness and remain unattached to outcomes.
 - Ask your partner at the end of the day what changes they noticed in your behavior.

Living with Mindfulness

- Mindfulness meditation helps **manage stress** by increasing awareness of present experiences and internal states.
- Fully embrace current life situations **with minimal resistance**.

Being Mindful of Emotions

- Watch emotions like anger with **compassion**.
- Reduces judgment, helping to **relax and let go** of emotional intensity.

Being Mindful of Eating

- Increase awareness during meals to improve eating habits:
 1. Look at the food and ask, “Do I really want to eat this?”
 2. Pay attention to every bite — **helps digestion and prevents overeating**.
 3. Notice how food affects your body — compare low-fat vs high-fat meals or candy vs vegetables.

Mindful Stretching / Yoga

- Gentle, slow exercises with **moment-to-moment awareness** of breath and sensations.
- Yoga **unites body, mind, and spirit** → improves health and vitality.

Mindful Breathing / Sitting Meditation

- Helps **relax and focus** the mind.

- Just **5 minutes a day** can refresh and energize.

FLOW

What is Flow?

- Flow = **total absorption** in an activity, forgetting self and basic needs temporarily.
- Examples from history:
 - Michelangelo painting the Sistine Chapel, absorbed for days despite hunger and fatigue.
 - Csikszentmihalyi noticed flow in work, play, and creative activities (chess, surgery, rock climbing).
- Flow = linked to **optimal development and functioning**.

Presence and Flow

- Flow and presence contribute to a sense of “**transportation**” — feeling fully immersed in a task or environment.
- Interaction with the environment enhances **control and responsiveness**, promoting flow.

Presence, Attention, and Flow

- Flow requires **initial investment of attention**.
- Too tired or anxious? Flow is harder to achieve → must overcome obstacles.
- Flow occurs when:
 - Skills fully engage a **manageable challenge**.
 - Challenges too low → increase them.
 - Challenges too high → acquire new skills to regain flow.
- Flow = **mental energy**, focused attention, and motivation.
- William James: Experience = what we **choose to attend to**; selective attention shapes consciousness.

Flow Theory

- Csikszentmihalyi studied **intrinsic motivation** — why people pursue goals without external rewards.
- Goal: Understand **momentary experiences** and conditions for **optimal engagement**.

Dynamics of Momentary Experiences

- Experience Sampling Method (ESM): Participants respond at random moments to record their current experience.
- Flow conditions are **consistent across work, play, and cultures**:
 1. **Challenges match skills** – neither too easy nor overwhelming.
 2. **Clear goals and immediate feedback** on progress.

Lesson 30:

Quality of Flow State

- Flow = **deep absorption in the present activity**.
- Intense concentration → **merging of action and awareness**.
- **Loss of self-consciousness** occurs as flow emerges.
- Maintaining flow is **challenging** due to distractions and self-criticism.
- **Mindfulness and nonjudgment** help achieve deeper flow.
- **Time spent in flow** = measure of flow quality.

Flow Experience – Statements

- “My mind isn’t wandering; I am fully involved.”
- “My concentration is effortless, like breathing.”
- “I don’t see myself as separate from what I am doing.”
- Example: Pele (soccer) felt euphoria, energy, and almost invincibility during games.

Autotelic Personality & Flow

- Autotelic = “doing things for their own sake,” not for external rewards.
- Traits: curiosity, persistence, low self-centeredness.
- People with autotelic personality:
 - Prefer **high-challenge, high-skill situations**.
 - Experience **less stress** in flow.
 - More likely to **enjoy life intrinsically**.
- Flow research suggests environment and personality influence flow experiences.

Longitudinal Flow Research

- Flow experiences are linked to **achievement over time**.
- Example: Teenagers identifying a talent at age 13 → predicted commitment to that talent at age 17.
- Students experiencing flow in early math courses → perform better later.
- Flow promotes **commitment, persistence, and achievement**.

Paths to Flow

1. **Find and shape activities** that naturally promote flow.
2. **Develop personal characteristics** (attentional skills, focus) to increase likelihood of flow.

Fostering Flow in Real Life

- Csikszentmihalyi helped workplaces and schools increase flow opportunities:
 - Swedish police → walk alone to focus better.

- Museums → display designs to make visits enjoyable.
- Key School, Indianapolis → students choose activities freely (“serious play”) → learn, grow, and enjoy.
- Clinical researchers use **experience sampling** to track and enhance flow.

Benefits of Flow

- Increases **persistence** and **skill development**.
- Absorption provides **intrinsic rewards**.
- Encourages seeking **more complex challenges**.
- Helps develop **life themes** → long-term goals and interests.

Personal Mini-Experiments: Finding Flow

1. **School / Study:**
 - Reduce screen time for 2 days → observe if concentration improves.
 - If it improves, reduce non-academic screen time during busy academic periods.
2. **Love / Relationships:**
 - Identify an activity that brings flow **for you and a friend** → do it more often together.
3. **Work / Career:**
 - Volunteer for **challenging tasks** → more likely to induce flow than easy assignments.
4. **Play / Recreation:**
 - Engage in activities that induce flow:
 - Chess, mountain biking, rock climbing, learning a new language, etc.

Lesson 31:

Understanding Spirituality and Religiosity

- **Spirituality** = search for the sacred; search for **meaning and purpose in life** (Ames & Samuels, 1999).
- **Religion** = organized expression of spirituality (e.g., attending services, praying).
- **Distinction:**
 - **Religious people** → follow concrete beliefs, actively participate in institutions.
 - **Spiritual people** → live their faith, use thoughts and feelings to guide life.
- Most people (75%) identify as **both spiritual and religious**.
- Spirituality and religiosity are linked to **higher life satisfaction**.

Pathways to Spirituality

1. Traditional organized religions (Muslim, Jewish, Hindu, Buddhist, etc.)
2. New spiritual movements (Sufism, feminist, ecological, goddess-centered)
3. **Spiritual strivings** include:
 - Purpose

- Ethics
- Recognition of the transcendent

Research Findings on Spirituality & Religiosity

Gallup Poll (USA, 1996)

- 96% of Americans believe in God.
- 72% say their **life approach is based on religion**, vs. 39% of psychiatrists and 33% of psychologists.

Death Anxiety (Suhail & Akram, 2002)

- Religious beliefs help **reduce fear of death**.
- Less religious people experience **greater death anxiety**.

Subjective Wellbeing (Suhail & Chaudhry, 2004)

- Survey of 1000 Pakistanis → **religious commitment predicts life satisfaction and happiness**.

Pakistan Earthquake Study

- Religious coping → **less distress** among survivors.

International Research

- Happiness & life satisfaction rise with:
 - Strength of religious affiliation
 - Frequency of attending worship services
- Spirituality is important in **healthcare and recovery**, including:
 - Mental health
 - Drug/alcohol abuse
 - Marital functioning
 - Stressful life events
 - Morbidity & mortality

Extrinsic vs Intrinsic Faith (Vicky Genia, 1996)

- **Extrinsic faith:** Using religion for **personal gain or social reward**
- **Intrinsic faith:** Psychologically **aligning oneself with faith**
- **Finding:** Intrinsic faith → more life satisfaction, less depression

Religiosity & Life Satisfaction

- **Early strong faith** → deepens with age → increases satisfaction (Hunsberger, 1985).

- Older adults → turn to God, stronger religious commitment → more desire to live (Markides et al., 1987).
- College students → pro-religious students feel **closer to parents/God** → less loneliness, more satisfaction (Richards, 1991).

Why Religiosity Improves Satisfaction

- Provides **meaning and purpose in life**
- Serves as an **inner resource** in trauma and stress
- Religious support → enhances **well-being, coping, and confidence**

Spiritual Needs of Inpatients

- 94% → spiritual health as important as physical health
- 77% → want spiritual issues considered in care
- 68% → no discussion of spiritual beliefs by physicians
- Prayer & holy visits:
 - Psychiatric patients → 80% & 65%
 - Medical patients → 88% & 66%

Lesson 32:

Measurement of Religiosity

- The **Revised Intrinsic/Extrinsic Religious Scale** was developed by Gorsuch & McPherson (1989).
- The **Religious Beliefs Inventory** (Ring, 1986) measures universalistic and spiritual orientation in near-death experiences.
- The **Spiritual Transcendence Scale** (Piedmont, 1999) has 24 items and three subscales:
 - **Universality** → belief in unity and purpose of life.
 - **Prayer Fulfillment** → feeling of joy and contentment from prayer or meditation.
 - **Connectedness** → sense of personal responsibility and connection to others.
- **Rehman's Religiosity Scale** is used specifically with Muslims.

Mini-Experiment:

- Relax for 5 minutes daily and think about life purpose.
- Explore different religions.
- Practice mindfulness during prayer.

Altruism

- **Definition:** Altruism is behavior aimed at helping another person.
- Altruism can be motivated by **personal egotism** or **pure empathy**.

Personal Egotism

- **Egotism** is acting to gain personal benefit.
- Egotism is a major human motive and can drive altruistic acts.
- Thinkers like Aristotle, Hobbes, Adam Smith, Hume, Nietzsche, and Freud debated whether altruism is driven by egotism, empathy, or both.
- Since the Renaissance, altruism has often been explained by **egotism**.

Forms of Egotism-Motivated Altruism:

1. Helping another person may bring public praise or monetary reward.
2. Helping can avoid social or personal punishment.
3. Helping may reduce personal distress at seeing another's suffering.

Empathy-Altruism Hypothesis (Batson, 1991)

- **Empathy** is an emotional response to another person's situation.
- Empathy may involve matching another person's emotions or feeling tenderhearted toward them.
- Altruism is aimed at improving another person's well-being.

Genetic & Neural Foundations of Empathy

- Heritability of empathy is measured by comparing **identical (MZ) twins** and **fraternal (DZ) twins**.
- Empathy correlation: MZ twins = 0.22–0.41, DZ twins = 0.05–0.09.
- **Mirror neurons** are located in the primary motor and premotor cortex.
- Mirror neurons are involved in understanding others' actions and empathy.

Cultivating Altruism

Egotism-Based Approaches:

- Doing good helps people feel better and increase self-esteem.
- Community volunteering is a practical way to cultivate altruism.
- Volunteer opportunities: children, disabled, elderly, hospitals.

Empathy-Based Approaches:

1. Interact more often with people in need.
2. Highlight similarities with others to enhance empathy.
3. Engage with people who see themselves as different to promote empathy.

Lesson 33:

Measuring Altruism

- Various self-report tools exist to measure altruism from childhood to adulthood.

- **Self-Report Altruism Scale (Rushton et al., 1981)** is a validated 20-item index for adults.
- **Prosocial Behaviour Questionnaire (Weir & Duveen, 1981)** is a 20-item teacher-rated scale on prosocial behavior.
- **Ethical Behaviour Rating Scale (Hill & Swanson, 1985)** is a 15-item teacher rating tool similar to the Prosocial Behaviour Questionnaire.
- **Helping Attitude Scale (Nickell, 1998)** measures beliefs, feelings, and behaviors related to helping.
- Women tend to score higher on the Helping Attitude Scale than men.

Sample Items from Helping Attitude Scale:

- Helping others is usually a waste of time.
- Helping friends and family is one of the great joys in life.
- It feels wonderful to assist others in need.
- Helping the elderly is not my responsibility unless they are part of my family.

Mini-Experiment:

- Imagine yourself as another person to find similarities.
- Practice altruism toward others.

Gratitude

- Gratitude comes from the Latin word *gratia* meaning grace, gratefulness, and graciousness.
- Gratitude is appreciating blessings received.
- According to Emmons (2005), gratitude arises when someone gives a benefit that is **costly, valuable, and intentional**.
- Benefits can come from people, events, or nature (e.g., surviving a natural disaster or medical crisis).
- Gratitude is valued in all major religions.

Philosophical View:

- Thomas Aquinas said gratitude is beneficial and motivates altruism.
- Thomas Hobbes said ingratitude is one of the worst human crimes.

Gratitude in Islam:

- Prophet Muhammad: “Gratitude for abundance ensures it continues.”
- Muslims say “**Alhamdulillah**” meaning praise and thanks to God.
- Gratitude reflects acceptance that God’s plan is ultimately good.

Gratitude in Christianity:

- God is the giver of all gifts and the foundation of thankfulness.

Cultivating Gratitude

- Emmons & McCullough (2004) studied ways to enhance gratitude.
- Writing a **gratitude journal** increases life satisfaction.

Advantages of Gratitude Journals:

- More exercise.
- Increased optimism.
- Feeling better about life.
- Greater enthusiasm, alertness, and determination.
- Improved progress toward health goals.
- Better interpersonal relationships.
- Higher academic performance.
- Increased energy, optimism, and restful sleep.
- Greater connection to others.

Naikan Meditation (Japan):

- Enhances gratitude by daily reflection on:
 1. What did I receive?
 2. What did I give?
 3. What troubles did I cause others?

Lesson 34:

Measuring Gratitude

- Gratitude can be measured by asking people to list things they feel grateful for.
- Researchers also code life stories for themes of gratitude.
- Barusch (1999) found older women in poverty often expressed gratitude.
- Kidney recipients often show gratitude toward their donors (Bernstein & Simmons, 1974).
- Survivors of Hurricane Andrew expressed gratitude for surviving the disaster.
- Gratitude can also be measured through behaviors.

Specific Scales

- **Multidimensional Prayer Inventory (Laird et al., 2004)** includes a 3-item Thanksgiving subscale (1=Never to 7=All the time).
- Thanksgiving items:
 1. “I offered thanks for specific things”
 2. “I expressed appreciation for my circumstances”
 3. “I thanked God for things in my life”

- Higher scores correlate with stronger religious practices like prayer.

Trait-like Self-Reports

1. **GRAT (Gratitude, Resentment, and Appreciation Test, Watkins et al., 1998)** – 44 items; measures resentment, simple appreciation, and social appreciation.
2. **Gratitude Questionnaire (GQ-6, McCullough et al., 2003)** – 6 items; 7-point Likert scale (1=Strongly disagree to 7=Strongly agree).

Sample GQ-6 Items:

- I have so much in life to be thankful for.
- When I look at the world, I don't see much to be grateful for.
- As I get older, I appreciate people, events, and situations in my life.

GQ-6 & Correlates (McCullough et al., 2002)

Higher gratitude correlates with:

- Positive emotions and vitality.
- Optimism and hope.
- Satisfaction with life.
- Empathy, sharing, forgiving, and benefiting others.
- Giving time to help others.
- Being less concerned with material goods.

Psycho-physiological Underpinnings of Gratitude

- Gratitude produces physiological coherence: synchrony between alpha brain waves and heartbeats.
- Appreciation increases synchrony, especially in the left hemisphere (McCraty et al., 2002).
- Frustration causes erratic heart rhythms; gratitude creates a coherent heart rhythm (McCraty & Childre, 2004).

Practicing Gratitude

Essential practices include:

- Keeping a **Gratitude Journal**.
- Keeping an **Encouragement Box**.
- Finding a **Gratitude Mentor**.

Personal Mini-Experiments:

1. **Count Your Blessings:** List five things you are grateful for at the start and end of each day. Meditate on each gift.
2. **Thanking Your Heroes:** Identify and thank the heroes in your life.

Lesson 35:

Definitions of Forgiveness

- Scholars have different definitions of forgiveness.
- **Thompson et al. (2005):** Forgiveness is freeing from negative attachment to a person who transgressed.
- **McCullough (2000):** Forgiveness increases prosocial motivation toward the offender.
 - Less desire to avoid, harm, or seek revenge.
 - Increased desire to act positively toward the offender.
- **Enright et al. (1998):** Forgiveness is abandoning resentment and negative judgment, fostering compassion, generosity, and love toward the offender.

Forgiveness in Islam

- Humans are responsible but make mistakes and need forgiveness.
- Islam emphasizes **Allah's forgiveness** and **human forgiveness**.
- Allah is most Forgiving; His names include: Al-Ghafoor, Al-Afuw, Al-Tawwab, Al-Haleem, Al-Rahman, Al-Rahim.
- We must forgive others to receive Allah's forgiveness.
- The Quran (Al-Shura 42:37) says believers forgive when angry.
- Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) forgave enemies, including those who persecuted him and killed his followers.
- Even Hind, who killed his uncle Hamza, was forgiven.

Evolutionary Basis of Forgiveness

- Forgiveness can break cycles of violence in humans.
- It lowers hostility and enhances group survival.
- Forgiveness produces positive feelings in bystanders, stabilizing social order.
- Forgiveness helps preserve the self, which is damaged during transgression.

Neurobiological Basis of Forgiveness

- Sense of self is located in **frontal, parietal, and temporal lobes**.
- Injury to self is registered via **sensorimotor input**, mediated by the **limbic system, sympathetic nervous system, and hypothalamus**.
- Forgiveness is directed through the limbic system and is associated with **positive emotions**.

Measuring Forgiveness

- **Heartland Forgiveness Scale (HFS, Thompson et al., 2005):** 18 items; measures forgiveness of self, others, and situations; 7-point scale.
 - Higher HFS scores correlate with more trust, flexibility, and less hostility, rumination, and depression.
- **TRIM (Transgression-Related Interpersonal Motivations Inventory, McCullough et al., 1998):** 12 items; 5-point scale.
 - Measures avoidance or revenge motivation toward offender.
- **Enright Forgiveness Inventory (EVI):** 60 items; assesses thoughts about a recent transgression.
- **Willingness to Forgive Scale (WTF):** 16 items; estimates willingness to use forgiveness as coping.

Cultivating Forgiveness

Forgiving Another Person

- Step 1: Realistically appraise the relationship.
- Step 2: Release negative emotions toward offender.
- Step 3: Reduce desire to punish the offender.

Cognitive & Affective Approaches

- **Spiritual:** God forgives everyone.
- **Humanistic:** We are all human.
- **Rationalistic:** All people are imperfect.
- **Empathic:** Understand offender's reasons.
- **Apologetic:** Requires offender's apology.
- Approaches depend on age, gender, socioeconomic factors, and previous injuries.

Worthington's REACH Model (1998)

1. **Recall** the hurt.
2. **Empathy** for offender.
3. **Altruistically** forgive.
4. **Commit** verbally to forgive.
5. **Hold** onto forgiveness.

Forgiving Oneself

- Shame = "I am a bad person."
- Guilt = "I did a bad thing."
- Self-forgiveness requires taking responsibility and letting go.

Forgiving a Situation

- Clients may blame life circumstances for problems.

- Therapy focuses on stopping negative thoughts and looking toward the future.

Lesson 36:

Mini Experiments: Forgiveness

- **Gone but not forgiven:** Use Gestalt therapy's empty chair technique to forgive someone who is dead or unreachable.
- **Spread forgiveness:** Practice forgiveness in workplaces or classrooms.

Attachment

Importance of Attachment

- Lack of love, affection, and belongingness causes loneliness and feelings of worthlessness.
- Detachment negatively affects growth and development.
- Love and attachment are necessary but not sufficient for healthy relationships.

Attachment as an Adaptive Response

- Attachment is partly biologically based and adaptive.
- Infants show attachment responses within minutes of birth:
 - **Rooting reflex:** prefer mother's face, voice, and smell.
 - **Moro reflex:** imitate caretaker's facial expressions.
- Mothers produce **oxytocin**, which influences parenting behavior and desire for companionship.

John Bowlby (1969)

- Studied orphaned and delinquent children.
- Attachment protects vulnerable infants in humans and other species.
- Infants show three responses to separation:
 1. **Protest:** cry and scream to regain caregiver attention.
 2. **Despair:** show sadness if protest fails, reducing risk of predators.
 3. **Detachment:** behave independently if left unattended too long.

Parent-Child Attachment

- Consistent caregiver responses lead to children's contentment and trust development.
- Adaptive parental behavior shapes proximity-seeking behaviors in children.

Attachment Styles & Later Adult Relationships

Bowlby

- Caregiver responses reinforce the desire for proximity.
- **Attachment styles:**
 - **Secure:** belief in worthiness of love and trust in others.
 - **Insecure:** belief of being unworthy of love and distrust in others.
- Insecure attachment can lead to developmental struggles.
- Secure attachment fosters better social appeal and relationships.

Mary Ainsworth (1979) – Strange Situation

- Child exposed to novel situation with caregiver, caregiver removed, and reintroduced twice.
- **Secure attachment:** balance between exploration and contact with caregiver.
- **Insecure-avoidant:** avoids caregiver on reintroduction.
- **Insecure-resistant/ambivalent:** shows hostility but seeks comfort simultaneously.

Attachment Determinants

- Two main factors influence attachment styles:
 1. Self-esteem (positive or negative).
 2. Perception of others as trustworthy.
- Attachment style can change after significant life events (e.g., divorce, abuse).

Mary Main – Adult Attachment (Four-Category System)

1. **Secure:** trust, not worried about abandonment, feel valued.
2. **Preoccupied:** trust others, but feel unworthy, fear abandonment.
3. **Dismissing-avoidant:** low trust, avoid intimacy, high self-esteem, self-reliant.
4. **Fearful-avoidant:** low trust, avoid intimacy, feel unworthy, fear rejection.

Lesson 37:

Research on Attachment Styles

- Insecurely attached children show less social competence and lower self-esteem.
- They show approach-avoidance behaviors that may lead to social rejection.
- Differences in attachment are influenced by child-rearing styles and culture.
- Individualistic cultures often encourage independence and less physical closeness.
- Japanese vs. American/German children show cultural differences in attachment styles.
- Securely attached children report positive family relationships.
- Insecurely attached children report emotionally cold and conflicted family environments.
- Secure partners can buffer negative effects of insecure partners and improve their intimacy and self-worth.

Flourishing Relationships

- Positive psychologists study what makes relationships thrive.

- They teach partners skills to enhance interpersonal connections.

Building a Mindful Relationship Connection (Harvey et al., 2001)

- **Minding:** Reciprocal awareness of thoughts, feelings, and behaviors of partners.
- **Making Relationship:** Partners make positive attributions for each other's behaviors.
- **Accepting and Respecting:** Empathy and social skills foster connection.
- **Maintaining Reciprocity:** Active participation in positive thoughts and behaviors maintains balance.
- **Continuity in Minding:** Planning and strategies help partners grow closer over time.

Creating a Culture of Appreciation (John Gottman)

- Positive comments in a relationship are like deposits in a bank.
- Negative comments act as withdrawals and threaten relationship stability.
- Gottman studies emotions, history with emotions, and "met-emotion" in couples.

Love Lab Research

- Couples are observed in a "love lab" during 15-minute conversations.
- Physiological signs like heart rate and blood pressure are monitored.
- Positive and negative interactions, repair attempts, and contempt are recorded.
- Predictions about relationship success can reach over 90% accuracy.

Behaviors That Foretell Divorce

- Criticism
- Contempt
- Defensiveness
- Stonewalling

Multidimensional Therapeutic Approach

- Therapy replaces negative behaviors with:
 - **Complaint:** civil expression of disapproval
 - **Culture of appreciation:** promotes positive behavior
 - **Acceptance of responsibility:** owning part of the problem
 - **Self-soothing & regulation:** control negative emotions

Capitalizing on Positive Events (Shelly Gable et al., 2003)

- Two independent processes affect relationships:
 - **Aversive processes:** eliminating negative behaviors
 - **Appetitive processes:** promoting positive relationships
- Sharing good news enhances personal well-being and relationship satisfaction.
- Partner responses influence the benefit of sharing positive events.

Responses to Good News

1. **Active/Constructive:** enthusiastic, asks questions, shows genuine concern.
2. **Passive/Constructive:** silently supportive, happy but reserved.
3. **Active/Destructive:** points out problems or downsides.
4. **Passive/Destructive:** shows little interest or attention.

Neurobiology of Interpersonal Connection (Schoore)

- Orbitofrontal cortex maturation is influenced by caregiver-child interactions.
- Secure attachment enhances self-regulation of emotions.
- Positive attachment stimulates brain regions controlling emotional and behavioral regulation.
- Secure early attachment can produce emotionally healthy adults.

Lesson 38:

Moving toward Balanced Conceptualizations

- Clinicians can develop balanced views of human behavior by following certain steps.
- Steps include: fascination with abnormal behavior, neglect of environment and positives, lack of developmental emphasis, difficulties understanding behavior in a cultural context, and limits of categorical classification systems.

1. Fascination with Abnormal Behavior

- People often ask: “Is that behavior normal?”
- Abnormal behavior has no single definition.
- Three common markers of abnormality:
 1. **Atypical:** deviates from standard behavior.
 2. **Maladaptive:** does not lead to socially accepted goals.
 3. **Psychological distress:** involves worry, rumination, or discomfort.
- To judge normality, consider frequency, duration, effect, context, and social influence.

2. Neglect of Environment and Positives

- We often ask: “Why did he do that?”
- **Fundamental attribution error** and **fundamental negative bias** can make us over-pathologize behavior.
- **Fundamental Negative Bias** involves:
 - **Saliency:** stands out or not
 - **Value:** negative vs. positive
 - **Context:** vague vs. well-defined
- **Beatrice Wright’s Four-Front Approach (1991):**
 - Assess deficiencies and undermining traits.
 - Assess strengths and assets.

- Assess lacks and destructive environmental factors.
- Assess resources and opportunities in the environment.

3. Lack of Developmental Emphasis

- Developmental psychologists study origins and functions of behavior.
- They explore cognitive operations, moral judgment, and personality.
- The Iveys' developmental counseling views pathological behavior as logical responses to life events.
- Contextual self includes personal/family history, community, multicultural issues, and physiology.

4. Difficulties Understanding Behavior in a Cultural Context

- Culture influences behavior, coping strategies, and social support.
- Individuals may have multiple cultural identities.
- Culture-bound syndromes exist.
- Understanding culture is critical for accurate mental health conceptualizations.

5. Limits of the Categorical Diagnostic System

- Psychologists have grouped behavior into “normal” and “abnormal” for centuries.
- Categorical diagnosis is not always reliable or accurate.
- McDermott (1980) found that psychologists often disagree on diagnoses even with the same cases.
- Negative diagnostic labels can create stereotypes and influence how professionals and individuals perceive behavior.
- Labels reduce perception of within-group differences and exaggerate between-group differences.
- Traditional labels often ignore individual strengths and positive characteristics.

Lesson 39:

Considering New Personality Dimensions

- Mental illness and mental health are **not opposite ends of the same continuum**.
- Oldham & Morris (1995) proposed a **dimensional approach** to personality disorders.
- Each DSM-IV personality disorder lies on its **own continuum of adaptation**.

Example of Personality Dimensions:

Personality Style Personality Disorder

Conscientious	Obsessive-compulsive
Self-confident	Narcissistic
Dramatic	Histrionic

Personality Style Personality Disorder

Vigilant	Paranoid
Devoted	Dependent
Solitary	Schizoid
Leisurely	Passive-Aggressive
Sensitive	Avoidant
Idiosyncratic	Schizotypal
Adventurous	Antisocial
Self-sacrificing	Self-defeating
Aggressive	Sadistic
Serious	Depressive

- Focus on **negative traits** ignores strengths and hinders optimal functioning.
- Goal of psychodiagnostics: understand needs and resources for therapy.

Preventing the Bad & Enhancing the Good

Two broad categories:

1. **Prevention:** stop negative outcomes.
2. **Enhancement:** increase positive outcomes.

Primary Prevention

- Aim: “Stop the bad before it happens.”
- Reduces likelihood of future psychological difficulties.
- **Universal prevention:** entire population (e.g., vaccines).
- **Selective prevention:** at-risk groups (e.g., low birth weight children).
- **Effectiveness:** Durlak & Wells (1997) found programs improve behavioral/social outcomes like medical procedures.

Heller’s Five Suggestions for Success:

1. Inform target population about risky behavior.
2. Make program attractive and motivating.
3. Teach problem-solving and resistance to regression.
4. Change norms or social structures that reinforce bad behavior.
5. Collect data to evaluate effectiveness.

Caveats:

- Illusion of invulnerability: people think bad things happen to others.
- Difficulty convincing people programs work.
- Delay in publishing prevention research.

Secondary Prevention

- Addresses problems as they begin.
- Similar to psychotherapy interventions.
- Over 400 types of psychotherapies exist.
- Psychotherapy consistently reduces severity and frequency of problems.

Effectiveness (Jerome Frank):

- Hope is the underlying process in all successful therapies.
- Agency effect size = 0.47 SD (16% better).
- Pathways effect size = 0.55 SD (19% better).
- Overall hope effect = 1.02 SD (35% better).

Primary Enhancement

- Aim: “Make life good” by increasing well-being.
- Hedonic well-being: maximize pleasure.
- Eudaemonic well-being: achieve meaningful goals.
- Evolutionary basis: humans seek pleasure in activities promoting survival and reproduction.

Ways to Enhance Psychological Health:

- Shared enjoyable activities, especially novel/arousing.
- Religious and spiritual involvement.
- Gainful employment.
- Leisure: relaxing, resting, good meals.
- Contemplation of internal/external environment.

Lesson 40:

Primary Enhancement: Physical Health

- Exercise improves fitness, stamina, and daily functioning.
- Physical activity increases confidence in performing daily tasks.
- Confidence from exercise boosts happiness and well-being.
- **Caveat:** Over-focusing on building strengths may cause imbalance in life.

Secondary Enhancement: “Making Life the Best Possible”

- Goal: augment positive experiences to reach peak performance and satisfaction.

Psychological Health Examples:

- Group experiences for deep relational pleasures.

- Existentialist reflection on life's meaning.
- Healthy competitions for personal growth.
- Collaborative achievements that surpass individual capability.
- Helping others (volunteering) produces strong well-being.
- Witnessing awe-inspiring acts of others evokes profound wonder.
- Engagement with arts (music, dance, theatre, painting) brings pleasure.

Personal Mini-Experiments:

- Helping others: tutoring, volunteering, assisting older or disabled people.
- Learning new skills to renew curiosity after adolescence.

Positive Environments: Positive Schooling

Objectives:

- Understand positive schooling principles.
- Learn importance of trust in teachers.
- Positive schooling focuses on **students' assets**, not just weaknesses.
- Poor teaching harms students; good teaching enhances growth.
- Snyder & Lopez's metaphorical schoolhouse includes:
 1. **Care, Trust & Respect for Diversity**
 2. Plans & Motivation
 3. Goals (content mastery)
 4. Hope
 5. Special Contributions

Care, Trust & Respect for Diversity

- **Care:** Teachers responsive and available provide a secure base for learning.
- Spending time with students is the most valued teaching trait (Bjornesen, 2000).
- **Trust:** Fosters psychological and performance benefits.
- Trusting relationships help manage challenging classrooms (Watson & Ecken).
- Positive teachers aim to make students look good and feel safe taking risks.
- **Respect for Diversity:** Students' backgrounds and opinions are valued.
- **WE/ME Viewpoint:** Cooperative learning promotes inclusivity.
- Example: "Jigsaw classroom" (Elliot Aronson) fosters collaboration.

Lesson 41:

Goals

Stanford Professor Carol Dweck's research shows that goals help target students' learning efforts. Class goals are most successful when materials are relevant to students' real-life experiences. Overemphasizing grades can turn students into "grade predators," focusing more on outperforming peers than on learning. This focus on grades has been linked to lower hope and higher test anxiety.

Plans

Teaching requires careful planning, similar to building science on accumulated ideas. Robert Cialdini suggests making material relevant through classroom demonstrations and at-home exploration of phenomena students encounter outside the classroom.

Motivation

Instructors model enthusiasm, which students absorb. Strengths-based instructors take questions seriously and provide thorough answers. Teachers enhance motivation by following up on questions, taking risks, and laughing at failed experiments. Group goal planning fosters teamwork energy. Praise motivates students best when delivered privately, avoiding discomfort or unhealthy competition.

Hope

Hopeful students believe they will continue learning beyond the classroom. William Buskist emphasizes that teaching is about caring deeply for ideas and students, inspiring them through passionate engagement.

Societal Contributions

Educated individuals give lasting paybacks to society by teaching children to think positively or sharing knowledge widely. Positive education turns students into teachers, spreading learning benefits to many others.

The StrengthsQuest Program

StrengthsQuest helps high school and college students succeed academically and in life. Created by Donald Clifton, it focuses on studying what is right with people rather than what is wrong.

Stages of StrengthsQuest

Stage 1: Students complete the Clifton StrengthsFinder to identify their five greatest natural talents. This assessment has been validated by over 100 studies.

Stage 2: Students use the workbook *StrengthsQuest: Discover and Develop Your Strengths in Academics, Career, and Beyond* to build their signature strengths in school efforts.

Advantages

Research shows students in StrengthsQuest report increases in altruism, confidence, efficacy, and hope. Participants can recognize their talents, apply them to areas matching their interests, and use their strengths to achieve goals.

Teaching as a Calling

Positive psychology views teaching as a calling rather than work. Teachers are intrinsically motivated, demonstrating profound love for teaching.

Example: Dr. Charles Brewer

Dr. Brewer views teaching as a noble calling. He helps students understand principles behind details, encouraging independent thinking. He wants students to ask “why” as often as “what.”

Lesson 42:

Personal Mini-Experiments

Power of Positive & Negative Teachers

- Think about a bad teacher from your school days who made you avoid school. Try not to condemn them now.
- Recall a superb teacher who made you look forward to their class.
- Henry Adams said, “A teacher affects eternity; he can never tell where his influence stops.”

Gainful Employment

Importance of Certain Aspects

- Hugick and Leonard (1991) surveyed what people value in jobs:
 - Health insurance ranked highest.
 - Over 50% valued interesting work, job security, vacation time, freedom, recognition, and chances to learn new skills.

Characteristics of Gainful Employment

- Eight benefits of gainful employment include:
 1. Variety in duties
 2. Safe working environment
 3. Income for self and family
 4. Sense of purpose in providing a product or service
 5. Happiness and job satisfaction
 6. Engagement and involvement
 7. Sense of performing well and meeting goals
 8. Companionship and loyalty to coworkers

Happiness & Job Satisfaction

- Job satisfaction research is extensive; by 2000, over 7,800 articles existed.
- Happiness at work increases overall life satisfaction.
- Correlation between job satisfaction and happiness ≈ 0.40 (Diener & Lucas, 1999).
- Employed people are generally happier than those without jobs.

Work & Well-being (Pakistani Survey)

- Survey of 1,000 people measured job satisfaction using questions like:
 - “I am successful in my job”
 - “My work is a source of satisfaction”
 - “I am satisfied with my work environment”
- Results:
 - Job satisfaction and happiness correlation = 0.31

- Job satisfaction and life satisfaction correlation = 0.39

Performing Well & Meeting Goals

- Judge (2001) meta-analysis of 300 samples (~55,000 workers) found performance and satisfaction correlation ≈ 0.30 .
- Career self-efficacy (confidence in managing career goals) is linked to success and job satisfaction.
- Clear goals and a high-hope boss increase work satisfaction.

Driving Purpose

- Purpose comes from feeling that one provides needed products or services.
- Workers want to contribute to society and help others, even in small ways.

Engagement

- Engagement is involvement in work when needs are met.
- Most engaging jobs match required tasks with employee skills and personality (Warr, 1999).
- Positive engagement predicts productivity and success (Harter et al., 2002).
- Example: Feeling “I have the opportunity to do what I do best” correlates with better work outcomes.

Variety in Job Duties

- Sufficient variety in tasks increases satisfaction and reduces boredom.
- Lack of variety can lead to presenteeism (working without productivity).
- Sometimes a varied, lower-paying job is better than a repetitive high-paying job.
- “Variety is the spice of life” applies to work settings.

Income

- A minimum income is necessary to meet needs.
- Money alone is not the main source of happiness.
- Example: Matthew Sanders (2003) created Triple P to reduce negative effects of parents’ long work hours.

Companionship

- Socialization among coworkers improves happiness and satisfaction.
- Gallup’s Vital Friends Assessment (Rath, 2006) showed workplace friendships increase productivity, happiness, and satisfaction.

Lesson 43:

Measuring Gainful Employment

Category Ratings:

Category	Importance Grade I x G		
Variety	4	3	12
Safe work	2	3	6
Income	2	3	6
Purpose	4	2	8
Well-being	4	2	8
Engagement	4	0	0
Performance	4	0	0
Companionship	4	4	16

- Mean Importance = 3.83
- Mean Grade = 2.13
- Total I x G = 56 / 28 = 2

Elements of Job Satisfaction: The Person

Positive Emotions

- Positive emotions at work enhance personal fulfillment and productivity.
- Isen (2002) found that positive emotions improve problem-solving, decision-making, creativity, and innovation.
- Employees with more positive emotions contribute more to organizational effectiveness (Pinder, 1998).
- Barry Staw (2000) suggested positive emotions can help people handle stress and adjust when jobs are not as expected.

Not Just Work – It is a Calling

- Amy Wrzesniewski (1997) identified three ways people view work:
 1. **Job:** Work is only for financial gains and earning a living.
 2. **Career:** Work is for achievement, competition, prestige, and satisfaction.
 3. **Calling:** Work provides personal fulfillment and purpose.

Being in Flow at Work

- Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi found that people enjoy their jobs more when they experience “flow” – a state of total engagement.

Emotional Intelligence at Work

- Some companies train managers to be “emotional coaches” for employees (Salovey, 2002).

Strength-Based Approach to Work

- Gallup Organization uses a strengths-based approach to hire and develop employees.
- Focus is on discovering employees’ strengths instead of fixing weaknesses.
- Clifton and Harter (2003) described three stages:
 1. **Talent finding** – identify employee’s natural talents.
 2. **Integration** – match talents with self-image.
 3. **Behavioral change** – apply talents effectively at work.

The Dark Side of Work

Workaholics

- Workaholics become obsessed with work, ignoring family and friends.
- They may show Type A behaviors: hypervigilance, anger, and strict time constraints.
- Life becomes unbalanced due to overworking.

Burnout

- Symptoms:
 - Feeling tireless and overworked without progress.
 - Sense of exhaustion and lack of reward.
 - Work demands keep growing despite best efforts.
- Burnout is cyclical: high energy at first, then it decreases over time.
- Most at risk: new teachers, helping professionals, social workers, nurses, managers.

Techniques to Reduce Work Stress

- Goal setting training
- Problem-solving skills
- Time management
- Aerobic exercises
- Relaxation techniques
- General coping strategies

Lesson 44:

The Dark Side: Losing Job

- Losing a job is a serious issue psychologically and physically.
- Dr. Margaretha Voss (2004) studied 20,600+ men and women in Sweden.
- Unemployment among men was linked to higher deaths from alcohol-related diseases and cancer.
- Unemployment can lead to:
 1. Economic decline
 2. Loss of social status
 3. Disrupted relationships
 4. Increased risk behaviors
 5. Lower psychological well-being
 6. Depression
 7. Severe physical illness

Making the Job Better

- Clinically, asking people their first thoughts about work can help identify needed changes.
- Employers can improve satisfaction by:
 - Flexible working schedules (IBM research shows this improves satisfaction).

A Positive Look at the Future of Psychology

Going Positive

- “To be broken is no reason to see all things as broken.” – Mark Leno
- Positive psychology is gaining attention in psychology and media.
- The Journal of Positive Psychology (2006) focuses on human strengths and positive emotions.
- Positive psychology provides a “feel-good” antidote to constant bad news.

Positive Psychology as a Worldwide Phenomenon

- Initially U.S.-focused, Seligman reached out globally.
- International conferences held:
 - Third Annual International Positive Psychology Summit (Washington, DC) – 23 countries attended.
 - European Network of Positive Psychology Conference (Italy, 2004).
- Globally, 7%-37% of major positive psychology scholars are outside the U.S.
- Positive psychology research has also started in Pakistan.

Young People and Education

- Introductory psychology courses include positive psychology.
- Nearly 100 universities worldwide offer undergraduate and graduate courses in positive psychology.
- Pakistan: some universities offer it as compulsory or optional courses.

- University of Pennsylvania offers the first graduate program entirely in Positive Psychology (Masters of Applied Positive Psychology).
- Positive Psychology Network funds 150+ scholars globally.

Major Websites

- www.positivepsychology.org
- www.apa.org/science/positivepsy.html
- www.authentichappiness.org
- www.bus.umich.edu/Positive/
- www.div17.org/positivepsychology

Women in Positive Psychology

- Promising involvement due to:
 - Attention to family and children
 - Interest in helping and physical health
- Women may promote:
 - WE-oriented approach rather than ME-focused
 - Prosocial actions in society
 - Physical health of others

Viewpoints of Major Positive Psychologists

Ed Diener – Imagine Our World If Positive Psychology Succeeds

- Key questions for the future:
 1. Are there cross-cultural universal virtues?
 2. Are there tradeoffs between virtues?
 3. Which forms of well-being benefit individuals and society?
 4. What interventions optimize happiness and virtues?
 5. How would the world look if positive psychology succeeded in making people happier, healthier, wiser, more virtuous?

Kenneth Pargament – Spirituality

- Spirituality is a unique human dimension.
- Positive psychology should expand understanding of spirituality in the 21st century.

Robert Emmons – Sacred Emotions

- Research needed on spiritual/sacred emotions: joy, gratitude, awe, compassion, contrition, zeal, etc.
- Collaboration required with evolutionary biology, neuroscience, philosophy, anthropology, cognitive science.

David Myers – Positive Communities

- Seligman's three pillars of positive psychology:
 1. Positive subjective well-being (happiness, optimism)
 2. Positive character (creativity, courage, compassion, wisdom, spirituality)
 3. Positive groups, communities, cultures
- Goal: Build social ecology that fosters thriving families, neighborhoods, schools, responsible media, civil dialogue.

Nancy Westburg – Learning from Disasters

- Study positive factors helping people rebuild lives after disasters.

Jamie Pennebaker – Acknowledging the Good and Bad

- Positive psychology is optimistic but must also recognize the darker side of human life.

Everett Worthington, Jr. – Urban Migration & Life Span

- Mass migration from rural to urban areas continues.
- Key challenge: Living together in stressful urban environments.
- Positive psychology can help through coping, forgiveness, reconciliation, and promoting human flourishing.

Corey Keyes – Health and Care for All

- Americans live longer, not necessarily healthier lives.
- Positive psychology should focus on increasing quality, meaningful, and healthy years of life.

Samuel Ho – Building Universal Positive Psychology

- Future development should promote global collaboration.
- Scholars in Asia should contribute to knowledge exchange in positive psychology.

Lesson 45:

Module 1: An Overview

Historical context:

- Pre-WWII missions of psychology:
 1. Cure mental illness
 2. Make lives fulfilling
 3. Identify and nurture high talent
- Wars caused focus on mental illness; Seligman coined **Positive Psychology**.

Perspectives on Positive Psychology:

- **Islamic:** True happiness = closeness to God; Prophet as human norm.
- **Western:**
 - Greek: Good life via logic/rationality
 - Jews: Self-identity through relationship with God
 - Christianity: True happiness via Jesus' message (love/compassion)
 - Renaissance/Enlightenment: Evaluate actions via utilitarianism
- **Eastern:**
 - Buddhism: Awareness/detachment → Nirvana
 - Hinduism: Reincarnation

Classification/Measures of Human Strengths:

- **StrengthsFinder** – Donald Clifton
- **Values in Action (VIA)** – Peterson & Seligman (2004)
- **Search Institute 40 Developmental Assets** – Benson et al., 1998

Module 2: Positive Emotional States & Processes

1. Positive Emotions:

- PANAS-X (Watson) measures positive/negative affect
- Isen (1987): Mild positive emotions → help others, flexible thinking, problem-solving
- Cohen: Positive emotions improve physical health
- Fredrickson (2000) – Broaden & Build theory: Joy expands possibilities

Happiness & Subjective Well-Being:

- Western Europe/North America: 8/10 rate life positively
- Determinants: Wealth, health, social support, faith, meaning

2. Making the Most of Emotional Experiences:

Emotion-Focused Coping:

- Stanton et al., 2002: Adaptive; helps understand feelings and habituate to stress

Emotional Intelligence (EI) – Salovey & Mayer, 1990:

1. Perceive emotions
 2. Use emotions to facilitate thought
 3. Understand emotions
 4. Manage emotions
- Measured via EQ-i (Bar-On) and MSCEIT

Emotional Selectivity – Carstensen:

- Later years focus more on positive emotions, relationships, and savoring “good stuff”

Emotional Storytelling:

- Useful for coping with: job loss, stress, illness, breakups
- Pennebaker paradigm: benefits for hostile individuals

Module 3: Cognitive States & Processes

Self-Efficacy (Bandura, 1997; Maddux, 2002):

- Belief in ability to achieve goals
- Antecedents: past success, modeling, visualization, persuasion, arousal
- Types: Situational, Trait, Collective

Optimism:

- Seligman: Learned optimism → adaptive explanations for negative events
- Scheier & Carver: Optimism = tendency to expect good things
- Instruments: ASQ (adults), Children’s ASQ, CAVE

Hope – Snyder (2002):

- Goal-directed thinking:
 - Pathways thinking: routes to goals
 - Agency thinking: motivation to pursue goals
- Linked to health, academics, sports

Positive Development Across Life Span:

Resilience – Children:

- Nurturing parent/mentor, social skills, creativity, coping style, faith, supportive figures
- Resources: Child, family, peers, community, risk- and asset-focused strategies
- Programs: Big Brothers & Sisters

Successful Aging (Vaillant, 2002):

- Not smoking, adaptive coping, no drugs, healthy weight, stable marriage, exercise, education

Wisdom & Courage:

- Wisdom: Balance intrapersonal, interpersonal, extrapersonal interests (Sternberg)

- **Courage:**
 - Physical → action toward valued goals
 - Moral → stand for truth/rights despite discomfort
 - Vital → persevere through illness/disability

Optimal Experiences:

- **Mindfulness (Langer, 2002):** Flexible mind, sensitive to context, behavior guided by awareness, reduces psychopathology, improves goals
- **Flow (Csikszentmihalyi):** High challenge + high skill → deep involvement, learning, self-esteem

Spirituality:

- Search for meaning/purpose
- Pathways: Traditional religions, newer movements, personal spiritual goals (purpose, ethics, transcendence)

Module 4: Prosocial Behavior

Altruism:

- Helping others without personal gain

Gratitude:

- Measurement: Journals, story themes, EEG-heartbeat synchrony (McCraty, 2002)
- Cultivation: Maintain gratitude journal

Forgiveness:

- Freeing from negative attachment to transgressor
- Measurement: HFS, TRIM, EVI

Attachment:

- Essential for love, belonging, long-term growth
- Parent-child attachment → adult relationships

Flourishing Relationships:

- Gottman's "Love Lab": Monitors couples' interactions, repair attempts, contemptuous behavior

Module 5: Understanding & Changing Human Behavior

Balanced Conceptualization:

- Avoid: over-focus on abnormality, ignoring environment, neglecting culture/development
- Steps: Fascination with abnormal, neglect of environment, lack of developmental emphasis, cultural misunderstanding, categorical limits

Enhancing the Good vs Preventing the Bad:

- **Preventing:** Primary & Secondary prevention; challenges include convincing people, time lag
- **Enhancing:** Primary & Secondary enhancement

Module 6: Positive Environments**Positive Schooling:**

- Focus on student assets rather than remediation

Metaphorical School House Model (Snyder & Lopez):

- Care, trust, respect diversity
- Goals, Plans, Motivation, Hope, Societal Contributions

StrengthsQuest Program:

- Identify students' talents, develop and apply them

Good Work / Gainful Employment:

- Duties variety, safe environment, income, purpose, happiness, engagement, performing well, companionship

Job Satisfaction – Person Factors:

- Positive emotions, work as calling, flow, emotional intelligence

Strength-Based Approach to Work:

- Identify strengths, match tasks, cultivate talent (Gallup Organization: Clifton & Harter, 2003)

Dark Side of Work:

- Workaholics → obsession, imbalance, Type A behavior
- Burnout → fatigue, lack of reward, cyclical energy loss, susceptible: new teachers, social workers, nurses, managers

Techniques to Lower Work Stress:

- Goal setting, problem resolution, time management
- Aerobic exercise, relaxation, coping strategies